

USNCC Consortium of Integrated Academic Services
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USNCC Naval Studies Certificate

USNCC Naval Studies Certificate:
Overview, Course Descriptions, and Student Learning Outcomes

NAV101 Naval Ethics & Leadership

Course Description

This course provides students with the foundational knowledge to assist them in understanding their role as a member of the United States military including their promise to “support and defend” the Constitution as well as be persons of exemplary character, worthy of moral praise. This course is centered around Moral Deliberation Road Map that includes three elements: moral deliberation, moral excellence, and the just war tradition which lends an understanding of how together we can fight and win with honor. It seeks to provide a deeper knowledge of the ethical demands of combat, and a basic understanding and contemporary thought in the theoretical complexities inherent in such service.

NAV 101 Course Learning Outcomes

1. Access the virtues needed for military service and reflect upon the ways in which they themselves can better inculcate those virtues.
2. Demonstrate and apply foundational ethical theories associated with constraints, consequences, character, and special obligations and apply them to resolve a moral dilemma.
3. Analyze how consideration of justice and rights function as constraints influence moral deliberation.
4. Explain the significance of special obligations and role-based morality for military service.
5. Apply the jus in bello criteria to determine the morality of specific actions within war: modern, historic, and potential.
6. Critically and creatively frame and solve problems.
7. Apply analytical decision-making to develop solutions for complex problems and issues using diverse decision-making processes.
8. Identify scholarly sources assessing bias and veracity of supporting evidence.
9. Assess the impact of cultural issues throughout the planning and execution of military operations.
10. Demonstrate the ability to leverage individuals' skills within a group to create superior outcomes
11. Develop written products that demonstrate the ability to effectively communicate complex topics clearly and succinctly

NAV102 Modern Naval History

Course Description

This course will provide students with an overview of modern naval history, with an emphasis on understanding the roles that the Naval Services (Marine Corps, Navy, Coast Guard) have played and how they relate to the relevant period of history and conflicts therein. Students will examine the key events that marked the evolution of the Naval Services and exercise critical thinking skills to understand the political, environmental, and societal causes and impacts of those conflicts. There will likely be an emphasis on writing in this class.

The Modern Naval History course includes a research and writing assignment.

Nav 102 Course Learning Outcomes

1. Explain the causes, context, chronology, and impact of major historical naval military development.
2. Describe how the character of naval warfare changes over time.
3. Evaluate how leaders solved historical problems in response to change.
4. Identify the technological, social, political, and economic factors that impact the Naval Service.
5. Critically and creatively frame and solve problems.
6. Apply analytical decision-making to develop solutions for complex problems and issues using diverse decision-making processes.
7. Identify scholarly sources assessing bias and veracity of supporting evidence.
8. Assess the impact of cultural issues throughout the planning and execution of military operations.
9. Demonstrate the ability to leverage individuals' skills within a group to create superior outcomes.
10. Develop written products that demonstrate the ability to effectively communicate complex topics clearly and succinctly.

NAV103 Naval Force Design

Course Description

The purpose of this course is to provide USNCC students with an understanding of how the naval forces are organized and the fundamental concepts that underpin naval operations. For the Naval Service to be prepared for contingencies within the spectrum of armed conflict, it is essential to integrate different components of the naval force and optimize them for specific missions or threats. This involves a layered system of warfare that aligns local military action to national objectives. In turn, this course will prepare students to recognize how elements of naval power can be applied across strategic, operational, and tactical levels of warfare.

The course will use historic examples to improve student's understanding of how the current state of naval force design has been developed, lead into the structures that comprise the Naval Service's force design, and explain the fundamental missions of the naval services and how they contribute to the Joint Force. The course will cover topics including the philosophy and organization of our naval forces, functions of the naval forces, and the operational concepts of the Joint and naval forces.

As students begin to align with the naval doctrine of warfare, it is vital that they understand how and why the current state has developed and be able to objectively examine with a critical eye. This course will allow students to demonstrate critical thinking skills, ethical reasoning, and judgment in applying naval doctrinal concepts to operational problems.

Nav 103 Course Learning Outcomes

1. Discuss current influences on naval force design using historical examples.
2. Illustrate the organization of the Naval Services, both administratively and operationally.
3. Identify what the current national security strategy requires of Naval Services in the context of geopolitics.
4. Describe current and futures threats to the Naval Service.
5. Discuss how the design of Naval Forces provide advantage against current or future threats
6. Critically and creatively frame and solve problems.
7. Apply analytical decision-making to develop solutions for complex problems and issues using diverse decision-making processes.
8. Identify scholarly sources assessing bias and veracity of supporting evidence
9. Assess the impact of cultural issues throughout the planning and execution of military operations.
10. Demonstrate the ability to leverage individuals' skills within a group to create superior outcomes.
11. Develop written products that demonstrate the ability to effectively communicate complex topics clearly and succinctly.

NAV104 Civilian/Military Organization and Policies

Course Description

The purpose of this course is to provide USNCC students with an overarching understanding of how the American political system is organized within the United States and the role that the Military has in that system. This course provides an introduction to American politics, along with an introduction to policies relevant to the Naval Services. The lessons taught in this course are developed to prepare service members to operate within the military construct of the American political system. This course also prepares students for further instruction on the concepts and theories of political science and public administration.

This course will cover the foundations of American politics, the history upon which it was built, the structures that comprise it, and how they interact with each other. Specific topics include the presidency, the U.S. Congress, the Supreme Court, the constitution, political parties, civil rights, elections, and military organization. Students will examine the range of factors, from historic and geographic issues to threats and risks from a multitude of sources, that have impacted the formation of our current day American political structure and military organization. Students will learn the roles and responsibilities that the military plays in the U.S. government, and the policies which govern the execution of military power.

Nav 104 Course Learning Outcomes

1. Be familiar with the historical origins of the U.S. political system and the role of the military within the system.
2. Be able to describe the structure, basic functions, and interactions of components of national, state, and local government in the U.S., especially among the three Federal branches.
3. Be able to describe the U.S. approach to national security strategy, the factors that shaped this approach, and how it operates today.
4. Understand the roles and responsibilities of the Department of Defense, the Services, and of individual Service Members within the U.S. system of government.
5. Critically and creatively frame and solve problems.
6. Apply analytical decision-making to develop solutions for complex problems and issues using diverse decision-making processes.
7. Identify scholarly sources assessing bias and veracity of supporting evidence.
8. Assess the impact of cultural issues throughout the planning and execution of military operations.
9. Demonstrate the ability to leverage individuals' skills within a group to create superior outcomes.
10. Speak formally and informally, employing rhetorical strategies suited to the audience and occasions.
11. Develop written products that demonstrate the ability to effectively communicate complex topics clearly and succinctly.

NAV105 Introduction to the Geopolitical Environment

Course Description

This course provides students with foundational knowledge to assist them in understanding the role of the United States in the international system, as well as the challenges it faces in the 21st Century. It seeks to address a series of critical questions: How did the modern international system develop? Who are the major actors? What are the major theories for understanding state behavior? What are the causes of war? What is the role of treaties, alliances, and international organizations? What specific challenges do our current adversaries (China, Russia, North Korea, Iran) pose to U.S. interests? What tools do the United States and its allies have in meeting these challenges? It concludes with a consideration of possible future directions and factors that will affect cooperative and competitive outcomes among states.

There is a research/writing assignment and a presentation required in this capstone course.

Nav 105 Course Learning Outcomes

1. Explain the nature of great power competition historically and its current manifestations.
2. Examine the structure of the international system and its basic components (states, alliances, international organizations).
3. Apply the basic elements of international laws and treaties.
4. Analyze the activities of non-state actors and their influence on international events.
5. Compare the core motivations behind today's major great power actors and the challenges they pose to the United States.
6. Critically and creatively frame and solve problems.
7. Apply analytical decision-making to develop solutions for complex problems and issues using diverse decision-making processes.
8. Identify scholarly sources for bias and veracity of supporting evidence.
9. Assess the impact of cultural issues throughout the planning and execution of military operations.
10. Demonstrate the ability to leverage individuals' skills within a group to create superior outcomes.
11. Develop written products that demonstrate the ability to effectively communicate complex topics clearly and succinctly.